

don't *need* each other. This is again a lie from the deceiver to suit his purpose. But, when God decides "enough is enough," we will again discover the reality of Psalm 73:25, which says, "Whom have I in heaven but Thee? And besides Thee, I desire nothing on earth."

Prior to Christ's return, we will again be molded into a working body, and no amount of insurance will be able to buffer us from needing each other. The community plan described in Acts 4:34 will be our "insurance" plan. This does not mean that the use of insurance is unscriptural, but the misuse of it is.

NET EFFECT OF AN INSURANCE ETHIC

Unfortunately, one of the bad side effects of relying so heavily upon insurance to buffer every little problem is that we also buffer God's guidance. There is no evidence in Scripture that God promises or desires to buffer His people from every difficulty or inconvenience. In fact, conversely, evidence exists that these circumstances are specifically allowed to redirect us or to "test" our faith (Romans 5:3; 2 Corinthians 8:2; Philippians 4:12; James 1:3). Thus, there is a "transfer" of trust from God to insurance when insurance is used in excess.

As previously noted, the apparently easy access to insurance company funds promotes an attitude of slothfulness, both financially and spiritually. Financially, because there is less incentive to save and anticipate problems, and spiritually, because there is less need to pray about future needs (of others as well as our own). Those who have access to employer-paid, low-deductible insurance plans have a tendency to forget that not everyone in their community has the same opportunity. Legitimate needs often go wanting because others lack the resources to "afford" the high cost of insurance.

EVALUATING LIFE INSURANCE

The purpose of any life insurance plan is after-death provision for those for whom we are responsible while we're alive. Many Christians have too little insurance, while others have